Figure 5.8 shows the actual Tx scan I created when I wrote this chapter. It shows the Tx hash, the block number with many confirmations (because it was recorded a while earlier), the From address of the Tx, and the To address (a smart contract address). Isn't it cool that you can see the Tx I created a while ago on the scan in the future when you read this book? Don't miss this exploration. This is a foundation for many things that you'll do in later chapters.



Figure 5.8 Tx of contract deployment recorded on Ropsten as seen on Etherscan

Now you can interact with the smart contract by using the user interface provided by Remix. Initialize the counter to 500, decrement it by 200, get the value (which should be 300), and increment it by 200. Then get the value again: it should be 500. You'll have to confirm each transaction in the MetaMask window that pops up. It takes longer to get the corresponding transaction confirmations for all these interactions on Ropsten than it does in the Remix local environment.

You have successfully deployed a smart contract on a public network for the first time. It's important to think about this: your contract is public to participants on Ropsten, so it is not private anymore. You'd better protect and secure any sensitive data that's transacted!

When you deploy a smart contract on a blockchain like Ropsten, where somebody else can interact with it, you have to realize that it's visible to everyone within the blockchain network on which it is deployed, whether that network is private, public, or permissioned. Although this